

Negotiations and Meetings



Negotiations

One of the most important forms of professional communication is negotiating agreements between parties who have opposing views and interests.

Carl Ransom Rogers (1902-87): American Psychologist known for his humanist/client-centered/person-centered approach. Championed openness, creativity, choice, reliability and other human traits that help people progress in life and profession. Drew upon the Freudian understanding of the human self.



We think we listen, but very rarely do we listen with real understanding, true empathy. Yet listening, of this very special kind, is one of the most potent forces for change that I know.

— Carl Rogers —

WUOLPES

Rogerian Strategy or Rogerian Conflict Resolution

- The Rogerian argument (or Rogerian rhetoric) is a form of argumentative reasoning that aims to establish a middle ground between parties with opposing viewpoints or goals.
- Developed by psychotherapist Carl Rogers and adapted to rhetoric by writing scholars Young, Becker, and Pike (in 1970), the speaker seeks compromise, acknowledging positive aspects of each party's argument to arrive at a mutually-beneficial solution to an issue.
- It is an optimistic yet optimal means toward conflict-resolution

(From:

[https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/academic_writing/historical_perspectives_on_argumentation/rogerian_argument.html#:~:text=The%20Rogerian%20argument%20\(or%20Rogerian,with%20opposing%20viewpoints%20or%20goals.&text=You%20may%20already%20use%20Rogerian,%2C%20and%20For%20romantic%20partners.\)](https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/academic_writing/historical_perspectives_on_argumentation/rogerian_argument.html#:~:text=The%20Rogerian%20argument%20(or%20Rogerian,with%20opposing%20viewpoints%20or%20goals.&text=You%20may%20already%20use%20Rogerian,%2C%20and%20For%20romantic%20partners.))

- You may already use Rogerian argument in your everyday life to negotiate with your friends, family, and/or romantic partners. For example, if you wanted to watch a comedy and your friend wanted to watch a romance, you might compromise by offering to watch a rom-com, as this offers each of you a bit of what you are looking for in that particular moment.
- Note, however, that this style of argument is decidedly less common in academic settings, where various empirical or theoretical notions of truth are often prized above the practical advantages of the Rogerian method.
- It is most suited for small/focus groups/meetings in offices

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Rogerian Argument

- According to Carl Rogers, when people cling to an illogical/unreasonable position and refuse to even consider any alternatives, it is not necessarily that they believe in that position but because the alternatives are threatening to their self-image.
- Rogerian argumentation is not a step-by-step method but a **general strategy**. Its goal is to create an atmosphere in which meaningful negotiations can take place.
- Can be non-negotiable if parties are at loggerheads and believe in absolute opposites. Or lead to non-optimal compromises.

Key steps in a Rogerian Argument

1. Finding a common ground
2. Knowing the audience/listener
3. Introducing the problem
4. Acknowledging the opposite side
5. Defining your own position
6. Putting the two sides together
7. Moving to a conclusion
8. Hearing the final take of the opposite party
9. Finalize by editing the main idea

PRINCIPLED NEGOTIATION

Roger Fisher, William Ury, and their colleagues at the Harvard Negotiation Project (founded in 1979) demonstrate four principles:

- Separate the people from the problem
- Focus on interests, not positions
- Invent options for mutual gain
- Insist on using objective criteria

On Negotiations (from Program on Negotiation or PON, Harvard Law School; official blog) <https://www.pon.harvard.edu/tag/negotiation-tactics/>

- Some negotiators work with hard-bargaining negotiation tactics, often successfully.
- They resort to threats, extreme demands, and even unethical behavior to try to get the upper hand in a negotiation.
- When negotiators resort to this behavior, they convey that they view negotiation as a win-lose enterprise.
- Avoid such hard-negotiations.
- Remember that there are typically better ways of meeting your goals, such as building trust, asking lots of questions, and exploring differences.
- In our lives as negotiators there will inevitably be times when we feel angry, frustrated, and mistreated. This is why it is important to be prepared with solid negotiation tactics.

<https://www.pon.harvard.edu/tag/negotiation-tactics/> (Contd...)

- Use cooperation and be ready to compromise
- See possible scenarios of mutual gain
- Be culturally sensitive, especially where negotiations are done internationally
- Leadership qualities
- Some possible places for negotiations:
Salary, leave, terms of joining or terms of leaving
- What you need: Analysis, right questions, active listening, assertiveness, preparedness, calmness
- *Sully: Miracle on the Hudson* (2016) about Capt. Chesley "Sully" Sullenberger

